

Word family: **air / airs / aired / airing / airy / airless / airborne**

Base word: air

Part of speech: mainly **noun** and **verb**

Related forms:

* **air** (n.) — 空氣；氣氛；神態；公開播出的內容

* **air** (v.) — 播出；晾曬；使通風；公開表達

* **airy** (adj.) — 通風的；寬敞明亮的；輕盈的

* **airless** (adj.) — 不通風的；缺乏空氣的

* **airborne** (adj.) — 空中的；經空氣傳播的

* **airing** (n.) — 播出；晾曬；公開討論

Useful expressions / extensions:

* **fresh air**

* **in the air**

* **on air**

* **off air**

* **air a programme**

* **air your views / grievances**

* **air out a room**

* **air-dry**

* **air pollution**

* **air pressure**

* **air travel**

* **air force**

* **air conditioning**

* **air quality**

* **air of confidence**

* **put on airs**

* **clear the air**

* **up in the air**

* **walk on air**

Meaning in this passage

> Being with him feels like opening a window and letting fresh **air** into a stuffy room.

Here, **air** means:

the invisible mixture of gases that we breathe — 空氣

So:

fresh air = 清新空氣；新鮮空氣

中文翻譯：

和他相處，就像打開一扇窗，讓清新的**空氣**進入一個悶焗的房間。

The whole sentence is metaphorical, but **air** itself is literal.

1. **air (我們呼吸的空氣) — 空氣**

This is the core literal meaning and the one used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> Let some fresh **air** into the room.

讓一些清新的**空氣**進入房間。

Practice 2

> Humans need **air** to breathe.

人類需要**空氣**來呼吸。

Practice 3

> The room was filled with cold **air**.

房間裏充滿了冰冷的**空氣**。

MCQ-ready definition:

air = 圍繞地球、由多種氣體組成、供人和動物呼吸的氣體混合物

2. **fresh air — 清新空氣**

Practice 1

> Let's go outside for some **fresh air**.

我們出去呼吸一下**新鮮空氣**吧。

Practice 2

> Open the window and let in some **fresh air**.

打開窗戶，讓一些**清新空氣**進來。

MCQ-ready definition:

fresh air = 清潔、流通、不悶焗的空氣

3. **air quality** — 空氣質素

Practice 1

> The city's **air quality** has improved.

這座城市的**空氣質素**有所改善。

Practice 2

> Poor **air quality** can affect health.

差劣的**空氣質素**會影響健康。

MCQ-ready definition:

air quality = 空氣清潔、安全或受污染的程度

4. **air pollution** — 空氣污染

Practice 1

> Traffic is a major source of **air pollution**.

交通是**空氣污染**的主要來源之一。

Practice 2

> The government introduced measures to reduce **air pollution**.

政府推出措施減少**空氣污染**。

MCQ-ready definition:

****air pollution = 空氣中含有有害污染物的狀況****

5. ****air pressure — 氣壓****

Practice 1

> ****Air pressure**** changes with altitude.

****氣壓****會隨海拔改變。

Practice 2

> Check the tyre ****air pressure**** regularly.

要定期檢查輪胎的****氣壓****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****air pressure = 空氣對物體表面施加的壓力****

6. ****air travel — 航空旅行****

Practice 1

> ****Air travel**** has become more affordable.

****航空旅行****變得更便宜了。

Practice 2

> She avoids ****air travel**** whenever possible.

她盡可能避免****乘飛機旅行****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****air travel = 乘搭飛機進行的旅行****

7. ****air force — 空軍****

Practice 1

> He served in the **air force**.

他曾在**空軍**服役。

Practice 2

> The country expanded its **air force**.

該國擴充了**空軍**。

MCQ-ready definition:

air force = 一個國家負責軍事航空作戰的軍種

8. **air conditioning** — 空調；冷氣

Practice 1

> The office has **air conditioning**.

辦公室有**冷氣 / 空調**。

Practice 2

> The **air conditioning** isn't working.

冷氣系統壞了。

MCQ-ready definition:

air conditioning = 調節室內空氣溫度和濕度的系統

9. **in the air** (在空氣中) — 在空氣中

Literal use.

Practice 1

> There was dust **in the air**.

空氣中有灰塵。

Practice 2

> The smell of coffee was ****in the air****.

****空氣中****瀰漫着咖啡香味。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****in the air = 存在於周圍空氣中****

10. ****in the air (figurative) — 有某種氣氛；似乎即將發生****

Practice 1

> There was excitement ****in the air****.

現場****瀰漫着興奮的氣氛****。

Practice 2

> Change was ****in the air****.

大家都感覺到****改變似乎即將發生****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****in the air = 某種情緒、氣氛或即將發生的事情令人明顯感覺得到****

11. ****an air of confidence / mystery — 神態；氣質；氣氛****

A distinct abstract noun sense.

Practice 1

> She spoke with an ****air of confidence****.

她說話時帶着一種****自信的神態****。

Practice 2

> The old house had an ****air of mystery****.

那座老房子帶着一種****神秘氣氛****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****an air of X = 某人或某地給人的某種外在感覺、氣質或氛圍****

12. **put on airs — 擺架子；裝腔作勢**

Practice 1

> He started **putting on airs** after his promotion.

他升職後開始**擺架子**。

Practice 2

> She never **puts on airs**, even though she is very successful.

即使她很成功，也從不**擺架子**。

MCQ-ready definition:

put on airs = 故意表現得好像自己比別人更重要、更有地位

13. **on air — 正在播出；直播中**

Broadcasting sense.

Practice 1

> The programme is **on air** now.

節目現在**正在播出**。

Practice 2

> We go **on air** at eight.

我們八點**開始播出**。

MCQ-ready definition:

on air = 電台、電視或網上廣播正處於播出狀態

14. **off air — 停止播出**

Practice 1

> The station went **off air** for several minutes.

電台有幾分鐘**停止播出**。

Practice 2

> The show is currently **off air**.

這個節目目前**沒有播出**。

MCQ-ready definition:

off air = 不在播出或廣播中

15. **air** a programme / interview — 播出；播放

As a verb.

Practice 1

> The interview will **air** tonight.

這個訪問今晚會**播出**。

Practice 2

> The channel **aired** the documentary last week.

該頻道上星期**播出了**這部紀錄片。

MCQ-ready definition:

air = 在電視、電台或其他廣播平台播出節目

16. **air** your views / opinions — 公開表達意見

Practice 1

> Everyone had a chance to **air** their views.

每個人都有機會**公開表達自己的看法**。

Practice 2

> She **aired her concerns** during the meeting.

她在會議上**公開提出自己的憂慮**。

MCQ-ready definition:

air your views/concerns = 公開表達自己的意見、憂慮或感受

17. **air a grievance** — 公開提出不滿

Practice 1

> Employees were invited to **air their grievances**.

員工獲邀**公開表達不滿**。

Practice 2

> He used the meeting to **air several complaints**.

他利用會議**公開提出幾項投訴**。

MCQ-ready definition:

air a grievance = 公開說出自己的不滿或抱怨

18. **air a room** — 使房間通風

Practice 1

> Open the windows to **air the room**.

打開窗戶讓房間**通風**。

Practice 2

> We need to **air the bedroom**.

我們需要讓睡房**透透氣**。

MCQ-ready definition:

air a room = 讓新鮮空氣進入房間，使悶焗或有氣味的空氣流出去

19. **air out something — 通風；散味**

Especially AmE.

Practice 1

> Let's **air out the room**.

我們讓房間**通通風**吧。

Practice 2

> I left the coat outside to **air it out**.

我把外套放在外面**散散氣味**。

MCQ-ready definition:

air out something = 讓空氣流通，以除去濕氣、悶味或異味

20. **air clothes / bedding — 晾曬；通風**

Practice 1

> She put the blankets outside to **air**.

她把毯子拿到外面**晾一晾 / 通風**。

Practice 2

> The bedding needs to be **aired**.

床上用品需要**晾曬通風**。

MCQ-ready definition:

air clothes/bedding = 把衣物或床上用品放在空氣流通的地方，以保持乾爽或除味

21. **air-dry — 風乾；自然晾乾**

Practice 1

> Let the clothes **air-dry**.

讓衣服**自然風乾**。

Practice 2

> I usually **air-dry my hair**.

我通常讓頭髮**自然乾**。

MCQ-ready definition:

air-dry = 不使用機器或熱力，而讓空氣自然把某物吹乾

22. **airborne** (在空中的) — 空中的；由空氣帶動的

Practice 1

> The plane became **airborne**.

飛機已經**升空**。

Practice 2

> Dust particles remained **airborne**.

塵粒仍然**懸浮在空氣中**。

MCQ-ready definition:

airborne = 在空中或由空氣支撐、傳送的

23. **airborne infection / disease** — 經空氣傳播的感染 / 疾病

Practice 1

> Some infections are **airborne**.

有些感染可**經空氣傳播**。

Practice 2

> The masks help reduce exposure to **airborne particles**.

口罩有助減少接觸**空氣中的懸浮粒子**。

MCQ-ready definition:

airborne = 可透過空氣傳播或懸浮的

24. **airy — 通風的；寬敞明亮的**

Practice 1

> The apartment is bright and **airy**.

這個單位明亮而且**通風**。

Practice 2

> I prefer an **airy room** with large windows.

我較喜歡有大窗戶、**空氣流通的房間**。

MCQ-ready definition:

airy = 有良好空氣流通、通常亦感覺明亮寬敞的

25. **airy (輕盈的；不沉重的) — 輕盈的**

Practice 1

> The cake has a light, **airy texture**.

這個蛋糕的口感**輕盈鬆軟**。

Practice 2

> The room has an **airy feel**.

房間給人一種**輕盈開揚的感覺**。

MCQ-ready definition:

airy = 感覺輕盈、不厚重、不擁擠的

26. **airless — 不通風的；缺乏空氣的**

Practice 1

> The room felt hot and **airless**.

房間又熱又**不通風**。

Practice 2

> The basement was dark and **airless**.

地庫昏暗而且**空氣不流通**。

MCQ-ready definition:

airless = 缺乏流通空氣、令人感到悶焗的

27. **clear the air** — 消除誤會；把話說開

A major figurative idiom.

Practice 1

> We need to talk and **clear the air**.

我們需要談一談，把誤會**說清楚**。

Practice 2

> The meeting helped **clear the air** between them.

那次會議幫助他們**消除了彼此的誤會和緊張**。

MCQ-ready definition:

clear the air = 透過坦白溝通消除誤會、尷尬或緊張氣氛

28. **up in the air** — 尚未決定；懸而未決

Practice 1

> Our travel plans are still **up in the air**.

我們的旅行計劃仍然**未有定案**。

Practice 2

> The final date is **up in the air**.

最終日期仍然**懸而未決**。

MCQ-ready definition:

up in the air = 某件事仍未確定或尚未作出決定

29. **walk on air — 欣喜若狂；非常開心**

Practice 1

> She was **walking on air** after hearing the news.

她聽到消息後**開心得飄飄然**。

Practice 2

> He felt as if he were **walking on air**.

他感到自己簡直**欣喜若狂**。

MCQ-ready definition:

walk on air = 因極度開心而感覺輕飄飄、非常興奮

30. **a breath of fresh air — 令人耳目一新的事物 / 人**

Very relevant to your passage's metaphor.

Practice 1

> Her new ideas were **a breath of fresh air**.

她的新想法令人感到**耳目一新**。

Practice 2

> His cheerful personality is **a breath of fresh air** in the office.

他開朗的性格為辦公室帶來一股**清新氣息 / 令人耳目一新的感覺**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****a breath of fresh air = 帶來新鮮感、活力或令人舒服改變的人或事物****

This is almost exactly the broader metaphor behind the Leo passage.

Important distinction 1: ****air vs atmosphere****

****air****

the actual gases around us.

****atmosphere****

can mean:

1. the gases surrounding a planet
2. the mood/feeling of a place

> fresh ****air****

清新空氣

> a relaxed ****atmosphere****

輕鬆氣氛

So for mood, ****atmosphere**** is usually more direct.

Important distinction 2: ****air vs oxygen****

These are not the same.

****Air**** is a mixture of gases.

****Oxygen**** is one component of air.

So:

> humans breathe ****air****

and use the oxygen in it.

Important distinction 3: **air** vs **wind**

air

the gas itself.

wind

air moving outdoors.

> cold **air**

冷空氣

> strong **wind**

強風

Important distinction 4: **air** vs **breeze**

air

general.

breeze

a light, gentle wind.

> fresh air

清新空氣

> a cool breeze

涼風

Important distinction 5: **in the air** literal vs figurative

Literal

> Smoke was ****in the air****.

煙霧在空氣中。

Figurative

> Excitement was ****in the air****.

現場瀰漫着興奮氣氛。

Same physical metaphor: something seems to surround everyone.

Important distinction 6: ****air of X vs atmosphere of X****

****an air of confidence****

often describes the impression given by a ****person****.

****an atmosphere of tension****

often describes the overall feeling of a ****place/situation****.

They can overlap, but their usual targets differ.

Important distinction 7: ****air a programme vs air a complaint****

Same verb, very different objects:

Broadcasting

> air a programme

> 播出節目

Expression

> air a complaint

> 公開表達投訴

The second metaphorically means "put it out into public view."

Important distinction 8: ****air a room vs air out a room****

Both mean 通風.

****air a room****

especially natural in BrE.

****air out a room****

especially common in AmE.

Both involve letting fresh air circulate.

Important distinction 9: ****airborne vs aerial****

****airborne****

in the air / carried by air.

> airborne particles

空氣懸浮粒子

****aerial****

related to or viewed from the air.

> aerial photograph

航拍照片

They are not interchangeable.

Important distinction 10: ****airy vs airless****

These form a useful contrast:

* ****airy room**** → 通風、開揚

* ****airless room**** → 悶焗、不通風

Your passage's **stuffy room** is much closer to **airless** than **airy**.

Important distinction 11: **fresh air** vs **a breath of fresh air**

Literal

> We need some **fresh air**.

我們需要呼吸一些清新空氣。

Figurative

> She is **a breath of fresh air**.

她令人耳目一新。

Your passage literally says **fresh air**, but the overall metaphor strongly evokes the figurative expression **a breath of fresh air**.

Important distinction 12: **air** = atmosphere vs **air** = manner

Compare:

> There was tension **in the air**.

空氣中 / 現場瀰漫着緊張氣氛。

> He had an **air of confidence**.

他有一種自信的神態。

The first describes an overall atmosphere; the second describes someone's outward impression.

Family-extension note

Air is a strong polysemy family because its physical core—

the invisible gas surrounding us

—has developed into several major branches:

1. ****physical atmosphere****

- * fresh air
- * air pollution
- * air pressure

2. ****aviation****

- * air travel
- * air force
- * airborne

3. ****broadcasting****

- * on air
- * air a programme

4. ****public expression****

- * air your views
- * air a grievance

5. ****impression / atmosphere****

- * an air of confidence
- * excitement in the air

6. ****ventilation****

- * air a room
- * airy
- * airless

7. ****figurative idioms****

- * clear the air
- * up in the air
- * walk on air
- * a breath of fresh air

These are genuine, well-established modern extensions, not merely different Chinese translations of one narrow sense.

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea
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air	空氣	breathable gas
fresh air	清新空氣	clean moving air
air quality	空氣質素	condition of air
air pollution	空氣污染	contaminated air
air pressure	氣壓	pressure of air
air travel	航空旅行	travel by plane
air force	空軍	military aviation
air conditioning	空調 / 冷氣	conditioned indoor air
in the air	在空氣中	literal presence
in the air (fig.)	瀰漫着；似乎將發生	atmosphere / expectation
an air of confidence	自信神態	outward impression
put on airs	擺架子	act superior
on air	正在播出	broadcasting
off air	停止播出	not broadcasting
air a programme	播出節目	broadcast
air your views	公開表達意見	express publicly
air a room	使房間通風	ventilate
air out	通風；散味	let air circulate
air-dry	風乾	dry naturally
airborne	空中的；經空氣傳播的	carried by air
airy	通風開揚的	well ventilated
airless	不通風的	lacking airflow
clear the air	消除誤會	remove tension
up in the air	尚未決定	unresolved
walk on air	欣喜若狂	extremely happy
a breath of fresh air	令人耳目一新的事物 / 人	refreshing change

For your original sentence

> Being with him feels like opening a window and letting fresh **air** into a stuffy room.

Here:

air = 空氣

and:

fresh air = 清新、流通、不悶焗的空氣

The literal image is:

****stuffy room****

→ window opens

→ fresh air enters

The figurative meaning is:

****adult routine feels stale****

→ Leo brings imagination and energy

→ life feels refreshed

So while ****air**** itself is literal, the sentence as a whole strongly suggests the familiar idea of:

**a breath of fresh air = 一股令人耳目一新的清新氣息**